

LEVEL 1 (K-2ND GRADE)

WRITING WITH A BEGINNING, MIDDLE, AND END

BEGINNING: This is where you write about your character and the world that he or she lives in. Then, you write about a problem that appears for your character.

MIDDLE: This is where your character tries to solve the problem. It's okay if he or she doesn't solve the problem on the first try! Remember that even good characters can make mistakes.

END: This is where your character solves the problem! The story is finished here. Ask yourself if your character learns a lesson.

EXAMPLE: Once upon a time, there was a bear named Lia. She lived deep in the woods, where trees grew, with sweet, purple berries. Lia loved those purple berries. But whenever she tried to reach up into a tree to grab a pawful of berries, she realized she was too short. When she tried to climb the trees, she found that she was too heavy, and the trees were too thin. Shaking the tree back and forth did not make many berries fall. And the berries that fell to the ground were never as yummy as freshly-picked ones. Lia was very sad about this. One day, she saw a raccoon named Rosie climb into a purple-berry tree and easily pick some of those delicious berries. She called up to Rosie. "Hello, Mrs. Rosie!"

"Hello, Miss Lia!" she called back, through a mouthful of berries.

"Do you think you would be willing to bring some of those berries down to me so I can have some, too? They are very yummy but I can't get many."

Rosie the raccoon thought for a moment. She finally said, "Well, how about this: I can bring you as many berries as you want, as long as you are willing to share your den with me this Winter. It is going to get chilly soon, and I need somewhere to live during the cold, snowy Winter. I hear that your den is nice and cozy, even when it's very cold outside."

Lia the bear scratched her ear for a moment, and then said, "That sounds fair to me!" Rosie the raccoon brought an armful of berries down the tree. They gently shook on the deal.

And so, Rosie the raccoon helped Lia get as many berries as she wanted, and Lia provided a nice, cozy place in her den for Rosie to stay during the Winter.

When winter came, and Lia went to her den for hibernation, she thought about her new friendship with Rosie, and realized that often, someone couldn't do something alone. She was thankful for Rosie and was happy to make the agreement with her.